

Camera that sees around corners

MIT researchers have developed a camera that utilises multi-bounce reflection and hidden geometry to take pictures outside the line of sight



The new action figure

Apple fanboys have a new way to prove their loyalty with this action figure of Steve Jobs himself price around \$80

Bazaar

Apple iPod Touch 4G

Fresh apples in the pod

The new Pod is sleek and slim and looks stunning, even with the screen off. The fascia looks like one plane of black glass – very stylish. Both the 3.5mm jack, and the charger slot now have a slight taper to their periphery, meaning part of the charger and the earphone plug, are visible from the rear, as is a single loudspeaker unit, with a neat, recessed chrome grille.

There are two cameras on the 4G. Both these can be switched between, with a simple on-screen option when the camera is activated. The front camera is a VGA one, whereas the rear one supports a still resolution of 960 x 720 pixels, or video recording at 720i.

A resolution of 960 x 640

pixels, while maintaining the same display size of 3.5-inches increases the pixel density. The result is a very crisp display. The sunlight legibility of the display is also surprisingly good. Viewing angles are poor, thanks to the super reflective display.

The newer iPod generates more heat, especially noticeable when charging the device, and while playing games. Battery life also seems to have taken a nosedive. With music playback, battery life is not affected as it is while gaming.

Bass levels are good. There is a good bit of impact and weight that will keep bassheads foot tapping. The slightly recessed mid-range seems to cause guitars to lack a bit of sizzle, and this makes guitar solos slightly less emotive and involving.



The highs are pretty extended, and there is good instrument separation.

For a price of ₹19,900, the iPod Touch 4G is a premium PMP with a lot of features. It excels at music, videos and gaming, making it a complete device, and if you can afford to spend this much, we highly recommend it.

Specifications

OS: iOS 4.0; Display: 3.5-inches, 640x960 pixels, 24-bit colour; weight: 101 grams; Capacity: 8, 32, 64 GB; Wi-Fi: 802.11n

Contact

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Web site: www.apple.com
Price: ₹19,900

8.0/10

Features9.0
Performance8.5
Build Quality8.5
Value for money7.0

Specifications

OS: Windows 7 Home Basic;
CPU: AMD Phenom II N930;
RAM: 4 GB DDR3
GPU: ATI Radeon 550v 1 GB;
HDD: 500 GB 5400 rpm
Screen : 15.6-inch WLED;

Contact

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Price: ₹42,900

6.0/10

Features6.0
Performance6.0
Build Quality7.0
Value for money5.5

Dell Inspiron M501R

Superior looks, inferior battery

The glossy surface of the Dell Inspiron is bedazzling. It has a brush metal glossy finish on the top flap as well as the palm rests. It looks quite elegant. M501R houses a quad core AMD Phenom II 930 processor along with 4 GB of DDR3 RAM. This is one of those rare laptops you see nowadays which has some portion of the base projecting beyond the hinge of the monitor. The M501R has three USB ports, of which two are located on the rear side alongside a VGA port - which is not really helpful. Mouse trackpad is quite responsive and supports scrolling gestures. The system runs a Windows 7 home

premium OS. The 15.6 inch screen has a glossy finish and is quite luminous.

In synthetic tests Like 3D Mark 06 it gave an overall score of 6064 which is quite good thanks to 1 GB of video RAM. Cinebench rendering gave an impressive score of 7756. Due to the quad core processor and 4GB of RAM, this laptop delivers the goods when it comes to processor intensive tasks. It completed a 100MB VOB to DIVX conversion task in under a minute. But the battery life is huge disappoint-



ment. In our battery life tests, it lasted a mere 3 hours, which is not good at all as we had just one video playing on the loop. With multitasking that number will go down further.

At a price of ₹42,900 it seems a bit pricey mainly due to the poor battery life.